



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Leman Virtual Academy

School Website: <https://lemanacademy.com/schools/arizona/leman-virtual-academy-k-8/>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Leman Virtual Academy Arizona (AZ 85712) presents a hybrid that clearly leans toward classical education, with explicit emphasis on a science of classical pedagogy—especially in its branding as a “classical education” delivered in an online charter setting and in explicit grade-level references to logic, classical studies, and composition. However, the public materials from the school stop short of evidencing several core elements that accompany a fully classical program in the traditional sense (notably explicit Great Books lineage, robust liturgical/theological foundations, and the full spectrum of classical pedagogy such as uninterrupted Socratic seminars, scholé-oriented rests, chanting, and a broad, book-centered curriculum across all grades). The school does demonstrate meaningful alignment in some areas (curriculum emphasis on logic and classical studies; parent partnership; live teacher-led instruction; and a cultivated sense of character formation). Overall, the school sits squarely in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category, with clear doors toward CLASSICAL potential if it deepens certain practices and language in its public communications.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence:** Public materials emphasize a classical approach and character formation but do not present explicit transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgical practice, or sacramental language in the documented content. The standout line is the claim of a “classical approach” rooted in mind and character, with no explicit liturgical or theological framing in the accessible materials. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present – 0; Negative keywords present – 0 (no explicit transcendental or liturgical signals found in the accessible content).
Why this rating: The absence of explicit references to transcendental realism, theology, liturgy, or sacred practice in the public materials suggests this category is not clearly classical in the religious/metaphysical sense, even though there is a focus on character.
- **Element 2: Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The program emphasizes forming mind and character via a classical approach; the Grade-Level Overview highlights mastery of classical studies, logic, and composition, which aligns with formation and the pursuit of wisdom rather than mere job-prep. Public statements stress character formation and the classical frame, even if not articulating a full telos.
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present – 1 (formation; character-related formation) ; Negative keywords present – 0.
Why this rating: Some elements of formation and the classical mission are evident (formation of character, mastery of logic/composition), but the explicit articulation of the true/good/beautiful telos or a fully formed paideia is not overt in the public materials.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The program references “classical studies,” logic, and composition in upper grades; history is included via history projects; the curriculum is described as rooted in a classical approach, with Saxon math and literature-oriented work noted. Great Books or Great Conversation are not explicitly named, but the presence of logic, classical studies, and history projects indicate alignment with core liberal-arts aims.
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present – 3–4 (logic; classical studies; history;

composition) ; Negative keywords present – 0.

Why this rating: There is a visible emphasis on core liberal-arts elements (grammar/logical thinking, history, and classical framing). The lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation mentions and verbatim “grammar, logic, rhetoric” trio in public-facing text keeps this category from full CLASSICAL, but it remains clearly aligned with classical curriculum tendencies.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence: Public materials emphasize live online instruction and a blend of synchronous/asynchronous work; there is no explicit mention of Socratic seminars, memorization work, chanting, or scholastic rest cycles as described in classical pedagogy rubrics. The most concrete pedagogy descriptors are “live, certified teachers” and “independent learning” via Schoology, with emphasis on accountability and structure rather than a ritualized classical pedagogy. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present – 0; Negative keywords present – 0 (no explicit Socratic/seminar, chanting, or scholastic language found in the public site text).

Why this rating: The pedagogical approach centers on online instruction and independent work, with less evidence of the full spectrum of classical methods (e.g., Socratic dialogue, memory, chant, or a restful scholastic rhythm) as described in the Six Essential Elements.

- Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: The school highlights “live, certified teachers” and “teacher relationships,” suggesting teachers who are central to the learning experience. There is mention of “the living curriculum” in the broader classical discourse, and the presence of teacher leadership in a virtual environment is clear. However, explicit language about teacher as models of virtue, portrait of the ideal teacher, or a “faculty as the living curriculum” is not directly spelled out in the public-facing materials. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present – 1 (live, certified teachers) ; Negative keywords present – 0.

Why this rating: There is a clear emphasis on teachers as the primary delivery mechanism (a hallmark of classical education) but the stronger, explicit “living curriculum” framing and “portrait of teacher” language is not overt in the public content.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: The school explicitly positions a robust Parent Partnership: parents as learning partners, ongoing communication, a home-school partnership, and family involvement in elementary years. The materials indicate that parents participate actively (e.g., heavy parent involvement in early grades, parent training, and digital platforms that support family engagement). This aligns strongly with classical models that involve parents as co-educators. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present – 2–3 (Parent partnership; learning partners; co-teachers; parent formation; book clubs; family involvement) ; Negative keywords present – 0.

Why this rating: The materials demonstrate a clear, intentional partnership with parents, with explicit language about parents as co-educators and participation in the learning process, which is a central indicator of classical practice in this domain.

Overall assessment (aggregate): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- The school shows clear classical branding, explicit mention of logic and classical studies in the curriculum, and a strong, proactive parent-partner model. However, it does not consistently demonstrate core elements like explicit Great Books/Great Conversation, liturgical/theological foundations, or the full suite of classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, scholastic-based rests, chant/memory-heavy practices) in the publicly available materials. The balance of evidence places Leman Virtual Academy in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category overall, with specific areas (Curriculum and Parents/Community) showing stronger classical alignment than Pedagogy and Religious Foundations.

What Would Move the Needle (only for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Make Great Books/Great Conversation explicit: Publicly foreground a Great Books program, with a named canonical list across grades and documented Great Conversation seminars or Socratic dialogues in upper grades.
- Expand explicit classical pedagogy: Include and describe Socratic seminars, memory work, recita-

tion, and chant traditions (scholé-inspired rests) within the lower and upper school pedagogy, with measurable outcomes.

- Integrate liturgical/theological framing where appropriate: If the school intends a religious dimension, name and document theology, liturgical practices, or sacred-tradition language to align with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria, while respecting non-sectarian or intended-faith policies as applicable.
- Strengthen teacher as living curriculum: Adopt explicit language and practices that teachers are “models of virtue” and “the living curriculum,” with professional development in classical pedagogy and a public statement of the teacher profile and student ideals.
- Deepen historical-cultural transmission: Emphasize Western civilization, classical texts, and primary sources in history and literature across grades (beyond project-based work) to align with the “Great Books” and “cultural transmission” aspects.
- Expand family formation outside of core homeschooling: Broaden parent education opportunities (seminars, book studies, parent groups) with published syllabi, schedules, and outcomes that tie into the six-element framework.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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